

8. Most rich state in minerals in India is –

- (a) Rajasthan
- (b) Madhya Pradesh
- (c) Bihar
- (d) Orissa

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

During the time, when this question was asked, the state of Bihar was rich in mineral production. According to Indian Bureau of Mines annual report 2023-24. Present situation in terms of mineral production on value Odisha > Chhattisgarh > Rajasthan > Karnataka > Maharashtra > Jharkhand.

9. Which State of India is called as the State of Minerals ?

- (a) Odisha
- (b) West Bengal
- (c) Bihar
- (d) Jharkhand

70th B.P.S.C Re-Exam 2024

Ans. (a)

Odisha is often referred to as the "State of Minerals" because it is rich in a variety of mineral resources, including coal, iron ore, bauxite, and chromite. The state accounts for a significant share of India's total mineral production. It has some of the largest deposits of bauxite and chromite in the country, as well as a substantial share of manganese and iron ore.

10. Given below are two statements. One labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R) :

Assertion (A) : Gondwana System of Rocks provides about 95% of the coal of India.

Reason (R) : Most of the ferrous and non-ferrous minerals are associated with the Dharwar system of rocks.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Codes :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are correct, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are correct, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (b)

According to Indian Minerals Yearbook, 2022 Gondwana system of Rocks provides 99.54% (until April 1, 2022) of the coal in India. The important coal-bearing areas of this series are Raniganj, Jharia, Karanpur and Bokaro of the Damodar Basin in Odisha, and the Pench Valley in Chhattisgarh and Madhya Pradesh. **Dharwar system of Rocks** : They are named Dharwar system because they were first studied in the Dharwar region of Karnataka. The Dharwar system is rich in ferrous and non-ferrous minerals.

11. Non-metallic mineral is :

- (a) Marble
- (b) Manganese
- (c) Silver
- (d) Lead

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

Marble is a non-metallic mineral among the given options. According to Minerals of Mine annual report 2023-24, India produces as many as 95 minerals, which include 4 fuel, 10 metallic, 23 non-metallic, 3 atomic and 55 minor minerals (including building and other materials). Manganese, Silver and Lead are metallic minerals. Silver is commonly found in acidic igneous rock mixed with lead zinc, copper etc.

B. Metallic Minerals

i. Iron-Ore

*Iron Ores in India are majorly found in Dharwar rock system.

Dharwar Rock System is economically most important rock system found in India.

Haematite and magnetite are the most important Iron Ores in India. About 79% haematite ore deposit are found in the Eastern Sector (Assam, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Odisha and Uttar Pradesh) while about 93% magnetic ore deposit occur in Southern Sector (Andhra Pradesh, Goa, Karnataka, Kerala and Tamil Nadu). Karnataka alone contributes 72% of magnetite deposit in India. Of these, haematite is considered to be superior because of its higher grade. Indian deposits of haematite belong to the Precambrian Iron Ore Series and the Ore is within banded iron ore formations occurring as massive, laminated, friable and also in powdery form.

*The high-quality iron ore (Haematite and Magnetite) is explored from **Bailadila Mine** of Chhattisgarh. Bailadila Mine is the **largest mechanized mine** of India. Iron ore explored from this mine is exported to **Japan** from **Vishakhapatnam Port**.



***Kudremukh** is a famous mine of Iron ore in Karnataka. Magnetite iron ore is majorly found in Karnataka. ***Nathra ki Pal** and **Thoor - Hundera region** of Udaipur are famous for Iron ore in Rajasthan.

*According to Indian Minerals Yearbook, 2022 Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Rajasthan, Tamil Nadu and Goa, which chronologically have the largest (till April 1, 2020) reserves/resources of iron ores (Magnetite) in India.

*Haematite ore in India is concentrated over the states of Odisha, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, Karnataka and Goa chronologically have largest (till April 1, 2020) Reserves/resources in India.

*According to Indian Minerals Year Book, 2022 in 2021 (P)India is placed at 4th largest in the world in terms of iron ore production.

1. In which rock system, out of the following, is iron-ore found in India ?

- (a) Vindhyan (b) Cuddapah
(c) Dharwar (d) Gondwana

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

Iron ore in India is found mainly in Dharwar rock system . Dharwar- rock system is the most important rock system in terms of economic value in India.

2. The iron-ore reserves of India are associated with which of the following rock systems?

- (a) Dharwar (b) Cuddapah

(c) Vindhyan

(d) Gondwana

U.P. B.E.O. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

3. Which of the following geological systems of rocks contain a rich reserve of iron ore in India?

- (a) Vindhyan system (b) Cuddapah system
(c) Gondwana system (d) Dharwar system

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2014

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

4. Which two of the following states are the leading producers of Iron-Ore in India as per the Annual Report of the Ministry 2020-21?

1. Odisha 2. Chhattisgarh
3. Jharkhand 4. Karnataka

Select the correct answer from the code given below :

Code :

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 1 and 4
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 2 and 4

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

According to Indian Minerals Yearbook, 2022, among the states Odisha recorded the highest production of Iron Ore 136.67 million tonnes, i.e., about 53.82% of the country's production in 2021-22. Chhattisgarh was at the second place with a production of 41.31 million tonnes, i.e., about 16.27% of the total production followed by Karnataka with a production of 40.33 million tonnes, i.e., about 15.88%, Jharkhand 24.72 million tonnes, i.e., about 9.74% of the country's production. The remaining 10.90 million tonnes i.e., about 4.29% production was reported from Andhra Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra and Rajasthan.

5. The two states of India, most richly endowed with iron ore, are

- (a) Bihar and West Bengal
(b) Madhya Pradesh and Odisha
(c) Bihar and Odisha
(d) Madhya Pradesh and West Bengal

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

According to IMYB, 2022 the States (according to option) which are rich in Iron Ore in thousand tonnes (Haematite + Magnetite) are as follows : Odisha (9409573 thousand tonnes), Madhya Pradesh (356999 thousand tonnes), Bihar (49494 thousand tonnes). Major reserves/resources of haematite are located in Odisha (9409 million tonnes or 39%), Jharkhand (4710 million tonnes or 20%), Chhattisgarh (4592 million tonnes or 19%), Karnataka (2835 million tonnes or 12%) and Goa (1197 million tonnes or 5%).

6. Which of the following is an iron- region

- (a) Siwan (b) Jharia
(c) Kudremukh (d) Singhbhum

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (*)

Kudremukh is famous for iron-ore mine in Karnataka. Mostly Magnetite iron-ore is found in Karnataka. Singhbhum (Current Western Singhbhum) are also famous for the Iron area.

7. Iron Ore is not available in which of the following Indian state-

- (a) Bihar (b) Madhya Pradesh
(c) Odisha (d) Punjab

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (d)

India has four major iron-ore producing regions –

North -East Region	Jharkhand, Odisha
Central India Region	Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Maharashtra
Peninsular Region	Maharashtra, Karnataka, Goa, Andhra Pradesh, Kerala
Other areas	Rajasthan, Gujarat, Haryana, West Bengal.

This is notable that at the time when this question was asked, Jharkhand was part of Bihar. Hence, the correct answer would be (d).

8. Which mineral is found in Nathra-ki-Pal area of Rajasthan?

- (a) Iron ore
(b) Copper
(c) Lead and Zinc
(d) Manganese

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

Nathra-Ki-Pal area of Rajasthan is famous for Iron Ore.

9. Match the List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the codes given below :

List-I (Mineral)	List - II (Country)
A. Silver	1. Chile
B. Mica	2. Russian Federation
C. Iron Ore	3. Mexico
D. Copper	4. India

Codes :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	4	2	1
(b)	2	3	4	1
(c)	3	2	1	4
(d)	3	1	4	2

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (a)

The matching of the countries in question and their related minerals is as follows :

(Country)	(Mineral)
Chile	Copper
India	Mica
Russian Federation	Iron Ore
Mexico	Silver

10. Which of the following Iron ores is mined at Bailadila?

- (a) Haematite (b) Siderite
(c) Limonite (d) Magnetite
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Haematite iron ore is mined at Bailadila which is located in Dantewada district of Chhattisgarh. Major reserves/resources of haematite are located in Odisha, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, Karnataka and Goa etc. Magnetite which is comparatively high grade in terms of percentage of Iron content is found in the states of Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Rajasthan, Tamil Nadu and Goa etc.

11. Bailadila mines are related to which mineral –

- (a) Iron ore (b) Coal
(c) Manganese ore (d) Mica

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

12. Which among the following is the largest mechanized mine in India?

- (a) Ratnagiri mine (b) Jaipur mine

- (c) Sundergarh mine (d) Bailadila mine
U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) (Re-Exam) 2015

Ans. (d)

Bailadila mine in the Dantewada district of Chhattisgarh is the largest mechanized mine in India. Bailadila Mine is connected with Vizag Steel Plant of Vishakhapatnam which exports iron ore to Japan.

13. Match the following :

Place	State
1. Bailadila	A. Odisha
2. Kendujhar	B. Karnataka
3. Balaghat	C. Chhattisgarh
4. Kudremukh	D. Madhya Pradesh

Code :

	1	2	3	4
(a)	A	B	C	D
(b)	C	A	D	B
(c)	C	A	B	D
(d)	A	C	D	B

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

The correct match is as follows –

Place	State
Bailadila	Chhattisgarh
Kendujhar	Odisha
Balaghat	Madhya Pradesh
Kudremukh	Karnataka

14. Consider the following statements and select the correct answer from the code given below :

- Richest deposits of iron ore are found in Karnataka.
- India is the second largest producer of iron ore in the world.
- Odisha is the largest producer of iron ore in India.

Code :

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) All are correct

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

According to Indian Minerals Yearbook, 2022 most abundant reserves/resources of Iron Ore (Magnetite) are found in Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Rajasthan, Tamil Nadu and Goa respectively. In terms of production, Odisha is in the first place. India is the fourth largest (2021, P) producer of iron ore in the world. Therefore it is clear that option (c) is correct.

15. Which of these states in India was ranked first in iron-ore reserves (2020-21)?

- (a) Jharkhand (b) Odisha

- (c) Karnataka (d) Chhattisgarh
M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

According to the data from the Indian Minerals Yearbook 2022, as of 01-04-2020, the states with the richest reserve/resource of Iron Ore (Magnetite & haematite) in India (according to option) are Karnataka, Odisha, Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh respectively.

16. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

- (a) Gold - Kolar (b) Coal - Jharia
(c) Iron - ore - Guntur (d) Diamonds - Panna

R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (c)

Guntur is not famous for Iron Ore. while Kolar is known for gold; Jharia is famous for coal and Panna is famous for diamond production.

17. Out of the following types of iron ore, a reserve of which type is largest in India?

- (a) Haematite (b) Magnetite
(c) Siderite (d) Limonite
(e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (a)

Haematite type of ores has the largest iron ore reserve in India. According to Indian Minerals Yearbook, 2022 the total resources/reserves of Haematite in the country are around 24057905 thousands tonnes as of 1 April, 2020.

18. Which of the following is an iron ore ?

- (a) Cinnabar (b) Bauxite
(c) Limonite (d) Pyrite

70th B.P.S.C. Pre-2024

Ans. (c)

In the given options, limonite is an ore of iron. Its chemical formula is $\text{FeO}(\text{OH}) \cdot n\text{H}_2\text{O}$. Magnetite, Hematite, and Siderite are other major ores of iron. Among the other options, Cinnabar is an ore of mercury, while Bauxite is an ore of aluminum. Pyrite or iron pyrite (chemical formula FeS_2) is also an iron ore; however, this sulfide mineral is primarily used for commercial purposes, such as in the production of sulfur dioxide and sulfuric acid, rather than as an ore of iron. Generally, it is not used for extracting iron.

19. Which of the following is one of the ore of iron mineral?

- (a) Chromite (b) Malachite
(c) Bauxite (d) Hematite

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.